The Email Matrix SOP - Get More Revenue From Email

Presented by Jeremy Haynes

Intention

The purpose of this document is to help you understand the importance and role of email marketing in the modern marketing era. We are finding across all businesses that we work with and run that email marketing automation has evolved and requires more attention and creativity than ever before.

Leads and buyers have been bombarded with trash email marketing for far too long, and that has desensitized them to it, for most brands they have watched their emails go unopened and unclicked for years.

Whereas we've seen email open rates in the 40-60% range consistently for brands we've been working with. In this SOP you will find examples, and practical steps to take along with softwares we leverage to generate the most revenue from your current list and future opt-ins. Let's begin.

Megalodon Marketing
a Digital Agency

Context = More Money

A majority of the businesses that we work with will generalize the emails that they're going to send to their leads and to their list in general.

This creates low open rates, low click-through rates, and an overall lack of excitement and general curiosity about receiving an email from your organization. Simply put, most organizations are going to send what we're going to call a robotic generalized sterile email to their list and they are shocked when they get low open rates and overall low email engagement.

One thing that we do to immediately drive up open rates, click-through rates, and revenue that's being extracted from the list and the leads that we're emailing to is we are going to create context as much as we possibly can based on the data that we have available to us within the CRM and from the segmentation we can create.

We have a client that markets to investors who want to have the company manage millions of dollars for them. Each investor that applies to work with this company has to answer with the amount of money that they want to potentially invest.

It ranges from:

- $1M or less
- $1M-$5M
- $5M-$10M
- $10M-$20M
- 20M-$50M
- $50M+

The difference between a lead that says they have only $1M to invest and an investor who says they have $50M+ that needs to be managed is WIDE to say the least.

They need to be treated differently, the strategies that are going to be deployed to manage their money are different, so therefore the communication in all ways needs to be crafted contextually for that person and their needs.

If the guy or girl with $50M gets treated the same and you go over strategies of turning $1M into 12% a year more it’s going to turn them off and you substantially lower your probability of converting that investor in this case.

Thankfully this brand hired me to consult with them in their first ever attempt to advertise. So we built it right from the ground up.

We had them create a video series that was emailed out in a sequence to each type of lead for strategies that would be deployed to best manage their desired investable range they had filled out in the application.

The concerns of these different ranges differ greatly too. These were also addressed in subsequent emails and communication from the company to these leads so each person knows their situation is known by the company, which makes people feel great.

Ever been on a call with a bank to resolve an issue and had to get transferred to someone else? How frustrating is it to have to repeat your entire story to the next customer service rep that you get handed off to? How good does it feel when the customer service representative you were just talking with takes that extra time to explain everything to the new rep before you get handed off?

Night and day difference for the feeling it produces inside of you. It's the same with your leads. When you actually take the time to tailor communication specific to the person's needs, wants and desires and you leverage all the data you've collected or have in your CRM from these leads you've got you'll increase your chances of them spending their money with you by a lot compared to how your odds are now treating your entire list the way you currently do.

I'm a big fan of a company called Fear of god. They sell clothes and I love the overall clean aesthetic, I'm also a big fan of the designer Jerry Lorenzo.

I've spent thousands of dollars (likely more lol) on clothes on their website, I'm not even sure if they have a physical location here on earth somewhere.

They have an immense amount of data on me from my buying history, browsing history, physical locations I've purchased from, and all of my preferences based on filters I've used on their site too.

The main things I've bought from them have been T-shirts, shorts, stretchy pants and some dress clothes. Every single thing I've ever bought from them is the color black, and it's only been mens clothes. I've never looked at anything else from them.

All I ever get from this brand though in my email is new collection announcements, new collaborations that they are doing, order updates after I buy things, and an occasional back in stock notification. I've never even got a thank you for being a customer message!

You know what I never get that would catch my attention more and increase my odds of buying 1000X more from them? An email that says, *"our latest black mens clothes in XXL."*

I live in Miami Florida here in the USA, I've never once gotten an email that says, "the perfect outfit for Miami summertime."

During the winter they sell a bunch of warm looking clothes, but they still have T-shirts and shorts and things I could wear here in the hot Florida temperament. Why have I never received emails like this?

The odds of me coming back and purchasing more frequently are exponentially higher when they talk to me based on what I usually do or want to do or want to buy or want to potentially buy based on what they know about me already.

And they have no excuses not to, they for sure have all that data stored in their CRM database on me and all their other leads and buyers.

Some of you reading this are sitting here thinking about all the application data you've collected, and how you can leverage it now that this is in your head, which is great.

Some of you reading this realize you've only been collecting surface data like name, email and phone number without getting anything else.

It's a best practice from your company from here forward that you ask at least one segmentation question in every lead form you've got, even if it's something simple like a newsletter opt in.

Get something, anything–that allows you to communicate to the person in a more specific way rather than just throwing them in that generalized email list you've got.

It's about slicing your list into smaller, more manageable groups, or "segments," based on certain traits they share. By getting to know these segments intimately, you can craft emails that speak directly to their interests, needs, and desires. This isn't just throwing messages into the void and hoping for the best. It's about precision, about ensuring your emails land exactly where they need to, resonating with each recipient.

Think of it as the difference between a shotgun and a sniper rifle. The shotgun scatters, hoping to hit anything in its path, but the sniper rifle? It aims, it targets, and it hits with incredible

accuracy. Your email marketing should be that sniper rifle, pinpointing your targets with messages that speak directly to them, at the right moment.

Here's a playbook on slicing your email list into more manageable, targeted segments, so your messages land with precision, not scatter.

1. **Who They Are: Demographic Slice** - Think age, income, job. Why chat about retirement plans with a college kid? Tailor your message to fit their life stage.
2. **Where They're At: Geographic Segment** - Location, location, location. It's not just for real estate. From local events to weather shifts, make your emails resonate with local flavor.
3. **What They Do: Behavioral Breakdown** - Look at their shopping behavior, website clicks, and past interactions. Like a detective, use clues from their actions to personalize your approach.
4. **How They Interact: Engagement Filter** - Some folks devour your emails; others glance. Segment by engagement to keep the avid readers fueled and try to rekindle the spark with the skimmers.
5. **Past Purchases: Buying Behavior** - Like a chef suggesting wine based on your meal, recommend products related to their past purchases. It's about enhancing their experience.
6. **Journey Stage: Sales Funnel Focus** - Tailor your content like you're guiding them down a path. Newbies get the 101 content, while veterans might see the finish line offers.
7. **Loyalty Level: VIP Section** - Roll out the red carpet for your regulars with exclusive deals or sneak peeks. Show them love, and they'll keep coming back.
8. **Almost Buyers: Abandoned Cart Crew** - For those who left their cart lonely, a gentle nudge or a tempting offer might just get them across the finish line.
9. **Their Pace: Email Cadence Club** - Some like it hot, some like it not. Adjust your send rate to match their preference, keeping them cozy and connected without the overwhelm.
10. **Interest Indicator: Lead Magnet Group** - Segment by the freebies they've snagged. It's a window into their interests and how you can serve them next.
11. **Opinion Owners: Survey Squad** - Use survey insights to tailor your messages, addressing their specific feedback or interests with precision.
12. **Membership/Subscription Status** - Different strokes for different folks. Customize your content based on the level of access or service they've signed up for.
13. **Seasonal Shoppers** - Some customers come alive during certain seasons. Identify these patterns and you can be there with the right offer at the right time.
14. **Event Enthusiasts** - For those who've shown up to your events, keep the conversation going. Offer resources, or tease the next big thing.

15. **Tech Tendencies** - Knowing if they're team mobile or desktop can help you design emails that hit the mark, visually and contextually.

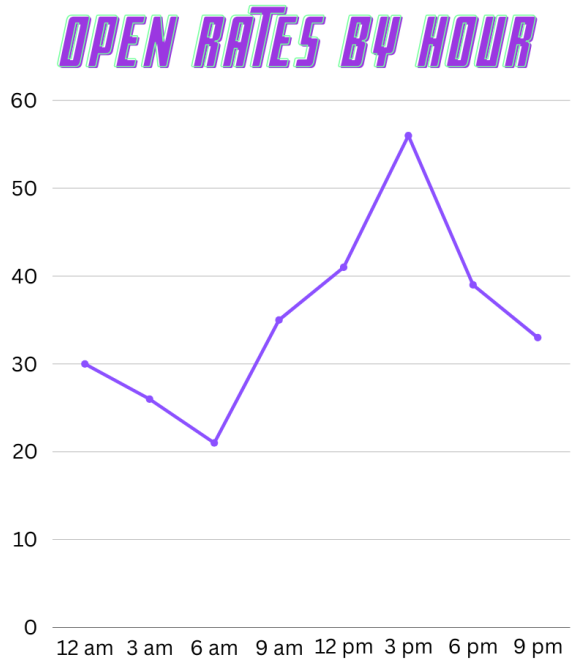
Remember, it's all about gathering intel and using it wisely. The sharper your segments, the more your emails will feel like they're speaking directly to each recipient, fostering a connection that's both meaningful and profitable.

Final thing on this, the literal how of the segmenting is typically done via tags in whatever CRM you are using. Tags are unique identifiers that you can attach to customer data in your CRM system. They allow you to group people based on their needs and interests so that when it's time for marketing, they get the right message at the right time.

Best time and days to send emails

This next part is some simpler data to help you drive up your overall email open rates and click through rates.

This is especially helpful to know so when you cook up an amazing contextual email you can send it at the perfect time. Verses when you want to send off your generalized emails that have lower odds of getting opened or clicked anyway you send those during the downtimes or days.



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We took email data from the businesses that we work with and compiled data from millions of emails that have been sent over a 365 day period so it wouldn't be time of year specific and we pulled data from many different niches so it wouldn't be business type specific.

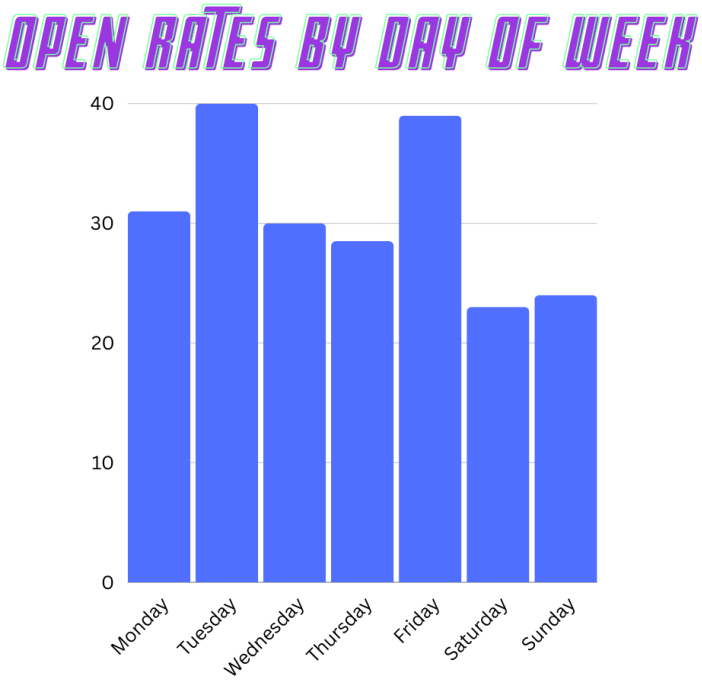
The best time of day to send emails was 3 pm in the person's timezone. That's right, not your timezone, their timezone.

The afternoon in general beat out everything else by a good amount, typically from noon to 6 pm was best.

The worst times were anytime after 9 pm through 11 am the following day.

One other trend I didn't find a way to visualize with this data about the perfect send time was noting it seems order notifications, or any kind of support based response emails were best in the morning. Whereas content and value driven emails that were lengthier or intended to get the person to browse for several minutes were best in late afternoon.

Now let's dive into the best days of the week to send emails pulled from the same data based on average open rates.



Tuesday and Friday beat out the next highest days by a full 9% additional open rate on average, with Saturday and Sunday being the worst days to send.

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Monday and Wednesdays weren't terrible, Thursday lagged behind those two a bit.

What we learned as an agency here was sending our more sales based emails that could lead to revenue on Tuesday and Fridays lead to more trackable revenue compared to any of the other five days of the week.

Seeing how low average open rates were on Saturdays and Sundays also discouraged us from sending sales based communications on those days.

We turned the weekends into content emails instead. We'd take videos from the brand that they were producing, and would drive email traffic to social media channels or educational funnels/lead magnets that had a lot of consumption time needed to get the full value from them since people generally have more time on the weekends for that.
We've also found most businesses have one part of the week that's great, and one part of the week that's slower. Rarely is a business that does great on weekdays performing great on weekends as well, it's typically one or the other.

Make sure you're aware of that trend inside of your business and playing into it so you can make more revenue from your list.

Immediately establish credibility

We had a client recently that is selling a course on how to get started with selling on Amazon. They are a well known personal brand with 2M+ followers on their social media channels, and the guy has generated over $35M since the inception of his personal brand.

He's got a couple hundred trust pilot reviews from students, testimonial screenshots from group chats in his communities, and backend Amazon sales dashboard screenshots and videos too to prove he's legit.

In his ads on Facebook, Instagram and Tik Tok he'd advertise an opportunity to go through a lead form or a VSL call funnel to speak with his sales team so the lead could get into selling on Amazon.

A consistent piece of feedback the sales team initially gave our marketing team was they were talking to leads who, "didn't know who we are."

The sales team was used to talking to organic leads from the social media channels who have already consumed several pieces of content and were familiar with the brand and the outcomes they could help with.

When you run paid ads for the first time to a sales team that is used to organic leads this is a very common thing you'll hear from them about people needing more sold on who the brand is.

We'll typically craft an email that is very simple that goes out before the scheduled call or if it's a lead funnel where the sales team reaches out right away we'll send this email off as soon as the lead comes in for the initial email.

It's what we refer to as the "keep it simple and remind them" email. What we're going to do is take a screenshot of the ad(s) they responded to, the sales page or lead form they filled out the form on, and we're also going to send them their application data that they answered with along with any links we can send them as well for wherever they originated from as a lead.

Everytime we do this simple email, we get a very positive response from the sales team that leads are coming in aware of why they are there.

It's amazing that leads just forget after minutes or a few hours that they took the time to go through your lead funnel, but it happens.

It's important to note that this email works best for leads that are then going to speak with a sales team, you do not need to do this for ecommerce brands or lead magnets where there is no sales team communication verbally happening.

Once they are reminded of where they originated from (if applicable) it helps tremendously for increasing show rates to sales calls and establishing familiarity bias which leads to higher trust right away.

In this email we'll also load it up with what we call "credibility assets." If we didn't need to send where the lead originated from, we will generally start off our sequence with this next tactic.

These credibility assets range from third party verified testimonial site like trust pilot, company website URLs, company addresses for physical locations, phone numbers, team photos, links to social channels, and anything that can give the lead information to consume that makes them conclude, "this company is legit, I'm excited to buy from them."

Credibility assets drastically increase the odds of a lead buying from your sales team in a shorter sales cycle.

If you're an ecommerce company and strictly selling online you can also add unboxing videos, instructional videos of what to expect or how to use the product, some of my favorite examples for this come from a company that was recently bought out by Herman Miller called Fully. Although we can't look at their amazing website anymore, we can still look at their extremely well executed videos for their site and email follow up.

With the following videos, they can easily create contextual emails that go out to their leads and buyers alike based on different segmentation.

For buyers of a standing desk they have, this first one is their instructional "how to put it together" video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7_YgJQzWcH4

Imagine you just bought a standing desk from them, and a contextual email they send you next is on their 'monitor arm' to mount onto the desk:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=op5uxRWIrH0

They also sold some of the best office chairs I've ever sat in, and when you bought one of the many types of office chairs they sold for desks you'd eventually be sent this video in an email if you hadn't purchased a desk from them yet: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1-LGXWaxAXU

The video above for the third party review from a youtuber criticizing their Jarvis standing desk could also be sent to buyers of the desk to lower buyers remorse and really sell the decision after purchase.

Same with this video from a 3rd party youtube reviewer channel on one of their best selling office chairs: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=54q9flQCQcA Great for many contextual email uses.

Here's a video with some of their staff saying thank you for all the great reviews they've gotten over the years averaging out to 4.7 stars out of 5:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2afpa85fJMU This video leverages the law of specificity for a highly believable number since it's 4.7 instead of 5/5 and also has many contextual use cases for email like asking for a review from a customer, or selling leads on how happy their past customers have been.

I have many products from Fully. I've bought three of their Capisco chairs from that video above, I have a massive Jarvis L shaped desk I'm typing you this on now, I've got monitor arms from them, and some other general office furniture. One thing I always saw on the site but was

hesitant to purchase was this “Balans Gravity chair,” but after I saw this video I was sold: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-wwrz1RXp4Q

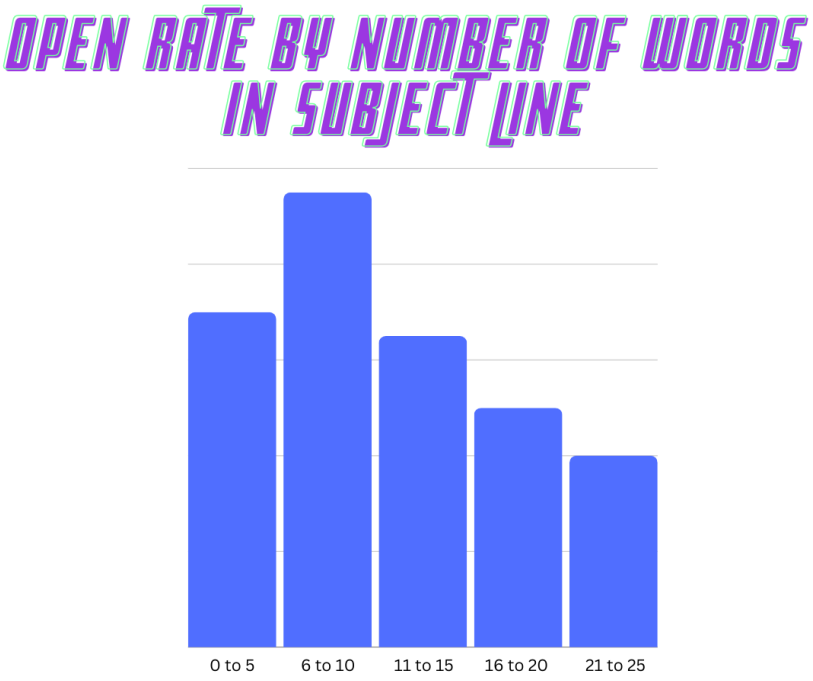
They had emailed me that video of the chair with a subject line, “zero gravity relaxation.” Keep in mind I love Fully and had bought many things up this point, and this is a $3,000 chair they were pitching me to buy. The video is what sold me, and I found the video after being emailed to watch it after announcing it as a new product in their ergonomic chair category.

I’m sure most of you reading this have bought from a sketchy ecommerce company before and you pray your item arrives and that your credit card information doesn’t get stolen, why do we get that feeling from some companies and not the ones we routinely shop with?

What are those little differences that make you trust businesses you actively buy from? Be self aware of those little things when going through a buying process and then go around and model them in your own businesses email follow up sequences.

Subject line tips

The following image represents the number of words in a subject line and how that influenced open rates. 6 to 10 words on average had the highest open rate by an average of 12% more compared to 0 to 5 words or 11 to 15 words.



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The rate of drop off was much greater above 15 words for negatively impacting open rates. This is likely due to the fact that a majority of email opens are happening on mobile phones nowadays.

The typical cut off on your average iphone screen is around 10 1-2 syllable words max, from there the rest gets cut off.

If you have an older demographic and you see in your data that a majority of your users are still viewing on desktop you can likely leverage longer subject lines to increase your chances of an opening.

In the digital age, personalization isn't just a luxury—it's a necessity. By weaving in elements like a recipient's name or location right into your subject lines, you unlock a higher level of engagement.

This approach, powered by what we'll call "Personal Touch Tags," boosts open rates significantly. They shine particularly bright when integrated with targeted outreach efforts, such as celebrating customer milestones or reinforcing connections post-purchase.

Be direct and concise with subject lines. While catchy seasonal phrases catch the eye, they often fall short of engaging the mind. Instead of leaning on "Falling into discounts" or "Hot summer steals," why not spell out the real value your audience will get? Highlighting the tangible benefits of your offer or pinpointing specific deals can turn a bland subject line into a compelling invitation.

In our fast-paced world, where emails are often skimmed on the go, less is more. Aim for subject lines that are concise yet impactful—no more than 9 words and 60 characters. This ensures your message is digestible at a glance, especially on the smaller screens of mobile devices.

Our investigations into email efficacy suggest a golden rule: keep your punctuation under control. A limit of three punctuation marks per subject line helps maintain clarity and professionalism. Overdoing it can inadvertently send your email into the spam abyss, especially with an overzealous use of special characters. I generally send without any punctuation and prefer lower case sentencing for max open rates surprisingly.

I hate using emojis in subject lines.

Emojis can add a splash of color and emotion to your subject lines, making them stand out in a crowded inbox. However, moderation and strategic use are key. Stick to a single emoji to

complement your message, not overshadow it. Remember, emojis can appear differently across various devices, so it's crucial to preview how they'll look to ensure your message stays clear.

To truly hit the mark with your subject lines, a bit of research and testing goes a long way. Utilize tools designed to refine your approach, from analytics on past performance to A/B and multivariate testing, which can reveal the preferences of your specific audience. By experimenting with different subject line versions, you'll discover what resonates best, ensuring your emails not only reach inboxes but also spark interest.

For an extra layer of insight, reviewing the open rates of your recent subject lines can illuminate what captures your audience's attention, guiding your strategy moving forward. I like to keep a doc of what's worked and what hasn't worked in the past. Check out my tops hooks and headlines doc for example of how this can look.

Beyond general guidance, specific data from A/B and multivariate tests can shed light on the unique preferences of your contacts. Most CRMs have a function to A/B test subject lines and emails by sending variant subject lines to different segments of your audience and analyzing which perform best, you refine your approach based on direct feedback, ensuring your emails not only land but also make an impact.

When writing emails in general and considering subject line copy, make sure to avoid words that trigger spam filters, here's a comprehensive list of what to avoid (source):

1. #1
2. 100% more
3. 100% free
4. 100% satisfied
5. Additional income
6. Be your own boss
7. Best price
8. Big bucks
9. Billion
10. Cash bonus
11. Cents on the dollar
12. Consolidate debt
13. Double your cash
14. Double your income
15. Earn extra cash
16. Earn money
17. Eliminate bad credit
18. Extra cash
19. Extra income
20. Expect to earn
21. Fast cash
22. Financial freedom
23. Free access
24. Free consultation
25. Free gift
26. Free hosting
27. Free info
28. Free investment
29. Free membership
30. Free money
31. Free preview
32. Free quote
33. Free trial
34. Full refund
35. Get out of debt
36. Get paid
37. Giveaway
38. Guaranteed
39. Increase sales
40. Increase traffic
41. Incredible deal
42. Lower rates
43. Lowest price
44. Make money
45. Million dollars
46. Miracle
47. Money back
48. Once in a lifetime
49. One time
50. Pennies a day
51. Potential earnings

52. Prize
53. Promise
54. Pure profit
55. Risk-free
56. Satisfaction guaranteed
57. Save big money
58. Save up to
59. Special promotion
60. Act now
61. Apply now
62. Become a member
63. Call now
64. Click below
65. Click here
66. Get it now
67. Do it today
68. Don't delete
69. Exclusive deal
70. Get started now
71. Important information regarding
72. Information you requested
73. Instant
74. Limited time
75. New customers only
76. Order now
77. Please read
78. See for yourself
79. Sign up free
80. Take action
81. This won't last
82. Urgent
83. What are you waiting for?
84. While supplies last
85. Will not believe your eyes
86. Winner
87. Winning
88. You are a winner
89. You have been selected
90. Bulk email
91. Buy direct
92. Cancel at any time
93. Check or money order
94. Congratulations
95. Confidentiality
96. Cures
97. Dear friend
98. Direct email
99. Direct marketing
100. Hidden charges
101. Human growth hormone
102. Internet marketing
103. Lose weight
104. Mass email
105. Meet singles
106. Multi-level marketing
107. No catch
108. No cost
109. No credit check
110. No fees
111. No gimmick
112. No hidden costs
113. No hidden fees
114. No interest
115. No investment
116. No obligation
117. No purchase necessary
118. No questions asked
119. No strings attached
120. Not junk
121. Notspam
122. Obligation
123. Passwords
124. Requires initial investment
125. Social security number
126. This isn't a scam
127. This isn't junk
128. This isn't spam
129. Undisclosed
130. Unsecured credit
131. Unsecured debt
132. Unsolicited
133. Valium
134. Viagra
135. Vicodin
136. We hate spam
137. Weight loss
138. Xanax
139. Accept credit cards
140. Ad
141. All new
142. As seen on
143. Bargain
144. Beneficiary
145. Billing
146. Bonus
147. Cards accepted
148. Cash

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149. Certified
150. Cheap
151. Claims
152. Clearance
153. Compare rates
154. Credit card offers
155. Deal
156. Debt
157. Discount
158. Fantastic
159. In accordance with laws
160. Income
161. Investment
162. Join millions
163. Lifetime
164. Loans
165. Luxury
166. Marketing solution
167. Message contains
168. Mortgage rates
169. Name brand
170. Offer
171. Online marketing
172. Opt in
173. Pre-approved
174. Quote
175. Rates
176. Refinance
177. Removal
178. Reserves the right
179. Score
180. Search engine
181. Sent in compliance
182. Subject to…
183. Terms and conditions
184. Trial
185. Unlimited
186. Warranty
187. Web traffic
188. Work from home

Why People Open Emails

Most marketers would think that the main reason someone is going to open an email is because of the subject line, that's simply not true as the dominating reason.

We surveyed the email lists of clients who would allow us to do so and then compiled the data into the visual below. The dominating reason people in your list open is because they are expecting it.

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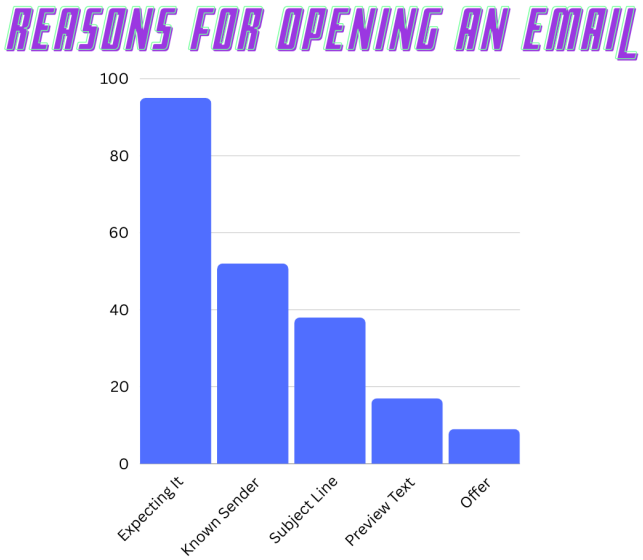


“Expecting It,” means they opted into something expecting an access email or email with whatever they opted in for. They contacted customer support and are expecting an email response back. They replied to an email for order support or with a question and are expecting a response.

This was the most dominant reason and after getting all the data back it also made the most sense. The follow up dominating reason that came in 2nd place was because the email came from a known sender.

Known senders have a higher likelihood of being opened, which also makes a lot of sense. When you shop with companies you love, you have a higher chance of opening any email they send because you love that company and work with them frequently. Same for brands or companies you support or newsletters you’re opted into and want to read.

Unknown senders would be classified as brands or companies that they have not heard from before, and are not expecting an email from.

Subject line came in 3rd place, and the preview text trailed after in a well behind 4th place with “offer” coming in last place.

With this data I’d encourage you to be thinking, “how can I get all of my emails to be expected.” That generally happens after someone knowingly opts in and is actively waiting for what you’re going to send.

We do this with “email options” which give leads the ability to select different options for what they want to see next, which also helps with further segmentation.

We’ll say something in most emails that are represented by buttons or links the recipient can select for what type of email they’d like to see next. Content, top videos of the week, newsletter content, offers/sales/discounts, more of the same, and whatever else is applicable to your company that leads might actually want from you that’s valuable to them.

Which brings us to our next point…

Provide actual value

In an era where inboxes are inundated with endless streams of "buy now" and "limited time offer" emails, standing out requires a shift in strategy. It's not about bombarding your audience with purchase prompts; it's about delivering real, tangible value. This section is dedicated to the art of providing actual value through your emails, not just relentless sales pitches. Particularly, we're talking about value that's tailored and contextual, rooted deeply in what you know about your recipient.

Why Value Trumps Sales Pitches

Imagine waking up, checking your email, and finding a message that speaks directly to a challenge you're facing or an interest you've been nurturing. That's the kind of email that doesn't just get opened; it gets saved, shared, and acted upon. Providing value creates a bond between your brand and your audience. It transforms your emails from interruptions into anticipated communications.

How to Provide Value

1. **Educational Content:** Share insights, tutorials, and how-tos that align with your audience's interests and needs. If you're a financial services company and you know a segment of your audience is new homeowners, send them a guide on managing home-related expenses or maximizing their investment.
2. **Personalized Recommendations:** Use the data at your disposal to offer personalized product suggestions, articles, or services. If someone has been browsing winter coats on your e-commerce site, a timely email with a curated selection of coats, along with care tips for winter apparel, can be incredibly effective.
3. **Exclusive Content:** Offer content that's exclusive to your email subscribers. This could be early access to sales, a sneak peek at new products, or content created specifically for your email list, like an in-depth industry report.

4. **Interactive Elements:** Incorporate polls, surveys, or quizzes that not only engage but also provide you with more insights into your subscribers' preferences. This interaction adds value by making subscribers feel heard and offering them content more aligned with their interests.
5. **Behind-the-Scenes Looks:** Give your subscribers a peek behind the curtain. Share stories about how products are made, introduce them to team members, or take them on a virtual tour of your office or manufacturing facility. This humanizes your brand and builds a deeper connection.

Context is Key

The golden thread that ties all these strategies together is context. The more you know about your subscribers—be it through their purchase history, engagement with previous emails, or information they've willingly shared—the more tailored and impactful your value-driven emails can be. Context transforms generic advice into "This was written for me" moments.

Start Small, Think Big

You don't have to overhaul your email strategy overnight. Start by segmenting your list and introducing one or two types of value-driven content. Monitor the engagement and iterate based on feedback. Remember, the goal is to build a relationship with your subscribers that feels personal, valuable, and rewarding.

By prioritizing value over sales, you're not just avoiding the spam folder; you're earning a spot in the daily lives of your audience. And when you've provided enough value, making a sale becomes a natural next step, not a leap of faith. This approach isn't just good email marketing; it's good business.

Understanding what email service providers want

Navigating the world of email marketing isn't just about crafting messages that resonate with your audience; it's equally crucial to understand the gatekeepers of the digital inbox: the email service providers (ESPs). These digital sentinels play a pivotal role in determining whether your carefully crafted emails reach the inbox or languish in the spam folder. This section uncovers the often-overlooked desires of email service providers and how aligning with their expectations can catapult your email marketing success.

Deliverability Is King

At the heart of what ESPs want is deliverability. They're tasked with the Herculean effort of filtering out the chaff while ensuring that valuable, wanted content reaches the user. To achieve

this, they scrutinize sender reputation, engagement rates, and the quality of content being sent. Your mission? To prove that your emails are not just wanted but welcomed.

Quality Over Quantity

ESPs are champions of quality. They prioritize senders who provide high-value content over those who bombard users with a high volume of low-quality emails. The mantra here is simple: send less, but send better. Quality content that engages and delights is your ticket to the inbox.

Engagement Drives Favor

Engagement metrics are like the pulse of your email marketing efforts, indicative of how well your content resonates with your audience. Open rates, click-through rates, and the frequency of interactions are all scrutinized by ESPs. High engagement rates signal to ESPs that your emails are valuable to recipients, thereby boosting your sender reputation and inbox placement.

Authenticity and Transparency

ESPs value transparency and authenticity from senders. This means clear "from" information, straightforward subject lines, and easy-to-find unsubscribe options. Misleading or deceptive practices are not just frowned upon; they're penalized. Being upfront and honest in your emails fosters trust not just with your audience but with the ESPs as well.

Consistency Is Key

Consistency in sending frequency and volume helps ESPs recognize and trust your sending patterns. Erratic sending behavior can trigger alarms, suggesting potential spam activity. Establish a consistent email schedule that aligns with your audience's expectations and stick to it.

List Hygiene Practices

Maintaining a clean email list is non-negotiable in the eyes of ESPs. Regularly removing unengaged subscribers, correcting misspelled email addresses, and managing bounce rates not only improves your engagement metrics but also signals to ESPs that you're a conscientious sender committed to maintaining a healthy email ecosystem.

Adherence to Regulations

Compliance with email regulations like CAN-SPAM, GDPR, and others is a clear indicator to ESPs that you're a serious and responsible marketer. These regulations are designed to protect

consumers, and adherence to them is a direct reflection of your commitment to ethical email practices.

Feedback Loop Utilization

Many ESPs offer feedback loops, a mechanism that notifies senders when recipients mark their emails as spam. Utilizing these feedback loops to adjust your strategy is a proactive way to maintain a positive relationship with ESPs and improve your overall email program.

Crafting Your ESP-Friendly Strategy

Understanding and aligning with the desires of email service providers is a strategic imperative. It's about playing by the rules of the digital inbox, ensuring your emails are crafted with quality, engagement, and transparency at their core. By doing so, you're not just ensuring your emails reach the inbox; you're fostering a positive, long-term relationship with both your audience and the gatekeepers who stand between you and them.

In essence, respecting what ESPs want is a critical component of your email marketing strategy. It ensures your messages are delivered, read, and acted upon, ultimately driving the success of your digital marketing efforts. Remember, in the realm of email marketing, success is a shared journey with your audience and the email service providers that connect you.

Softwares to Help You Elevate Your Email Game

Diving into the world of email marketing with the right tools at your disposal can transform your strategy from good to great. While the mainstream giants like Mailchimp have their place, the real game-changers are often found off the beaten path, in tools that bring a level of sophistication and efficiency to your email campaigns. This section highlights some of the lesser-known, advanced software options that will make even the most seasoned marketers nod in approval, thinking, "This guy knows his stuff."

Lemwarm

Starting with Lemwarm, a tool that's not just another email automation platform but a powerful ally in improving your email deliverability. Lemwarm helps you warm up your email account, gradually increasing the volume of emails sent from your domain and ensuring they land in the inbox rather than the spam folder. It's like a pre-workout for your email campaigns, ensuring your emails are fit and ready to achieve maximum engagement. By mimicking human behavior

and interactions, Lemwarm ensures your emails are seen as trustworthy by email service providers, boosting your sender reputation right from the get-go.

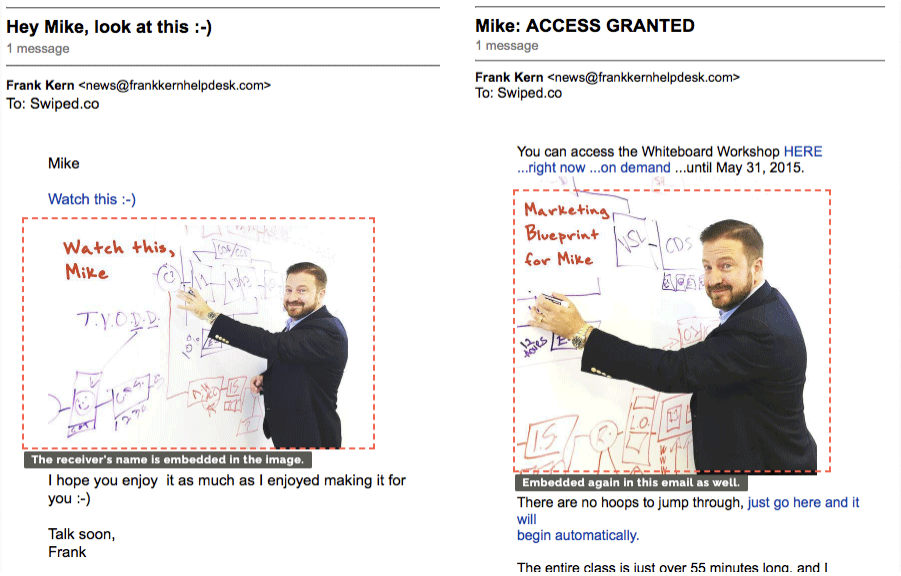
Lemlist

Next up is Lemlist, a tool that goes beyond mere email sending to offer personalized email outreach at scale. What sets Lemlist apart is its ability to customize not just the text of your emails but also the images and videos, allowing for a level of personalization that's hard to ignore. Imagine sending an email to a prospect with an image that includes their name or company logo, all automated and scaled across your campaign. Lemlist makes this possible, turning cold outreach into warm conversations and elevating your email campaigns with creativity and personal touch.

Dynamic Image Embed Softwares

Imagine receiving an email that has a photo of the founder of the brand holding a piece of paper that has your name on it sent via email to get a wow effect right away. It's not only possible, but super cool. Other great uses for this are a shipping team holding a box with the person's shipping info on it in the photo for an "we want to send this to you" or an order confirmation email. Some examples of this are Klaviyo, most CRMs will allow this, and if yours doesn't have this then you can get a tool like NiftyImages to do it for you. Here's the Kalviyo instructions on how to execute this as an example of the function:
https://help.klaviyo.com/hc/en-us/articles/4408810769307

Here's a visual example of this:



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Reply.io

For those looking to streamline their sales outreach and follow-up process, Reply.io is a powerhouse. It offers a seamless way to automate personalized email sequences, LinkedIn outreach, and calls within a single platform. Reply.io is designed for sales teams looking to boost their efficiency but is equally powerful for solopreneurs and marketers aiming to personalize their outreach at scale. Its analytics and AI-powered features help optimize your campaigns for the highest engagement, making it a smart choice for anyone serious about their email strategy. I like this better than close.com but close.com is very similar. Gohighlevel is also a notable contender for doing everything that reply.io does but with a worse user interface in my personal opinion.

Mailshake

Mailshake is a favorite for marketers and sales professionals focused on cold email, social selling, and phone outreach. What makes Mailshake a standout tool is its simplicity combined with powerful automation and personalization features. It allows users to create campaigns that feel personal, despite reaching hundreds or thousands of prospects. Plus, its built-in A/B testing capabilities and detailed performance analytics help refine your approach for maximum impact.

Brevo

While Brevo may be slightly more well-known, it's for a good reason. It's an all-in-one platform that covers not just email marketing but also SMS campaigns, chat, and CRM. Its advanced segmentation features and automation workflows allow for highly targeted campaigns that speak directly to the user's needs and behaviors. For those looking to manage all their digital marketing efforts under one roof, Brevo offers a comprehensive solution that's both advanced and user-friendly.

Hunter Campaigns

Hunter Campaigns is a hidden gem for those in the business of B2B email outreach. Part of the Hunter suite, known for its domain search and email verification tools, Hunter Campaigns focuses on simplicity and effectiveness. It allows you to send cold email campaigns directly from your mailbox, ensuring high deliverability and personal touch. It's particularly useful for those looking to connect with other businesses or professionals in a way that's direct yet respectful of the recipient's inbox.

Wrapping Up

Arming yourself with the right tools is crucial in the ever-evolving landscape of email marketing. While the giants in the industry have their place, exploring advanced, specialized software can

uncover new possibilities and efficiencies in your strategy. Whether you're warming up your email account, personalizing outreach on a massive scale, or managing comprehensive digital marketing campaigns, these tools offer the cutting-edge capabilities needed to stand out in a crowded inbox.

Engagement Bait Tactics

Occasionally you need an extremely high response rate from an email to generate a ton of leads for the sales team or to simply juice your email stats for the email service providers to judge you better. My favorite one to use is the “sent from iphone” engagement bait.

This email is short, sweet, and looks like you typed it on your iphone and sent it straight to the person. It typically looks like this:

following up Inbox ×

Grant [redacted] via infusionmai... Thu, Feb 4, 2016, 5:09 PM
to me

Hey Jeremy did you get my [redacted] special? Let me know

Sent from my iPhone

[redacted]

Having trouble viewing this email? Click here

If you no longer wish to receive our emails and give up on the hustle, click the link below:
Unsubscribe

I blacked out the sender here because my old boss doesn't like me using his name to do things that make money without him getting a cut and I respect that 🫡

This particular email when I sent it off to 400,000+ people in the list who hadn't bought the $997 special yet for a product generated THOUSANDS of replies.

It generated so many responses, that multiple departments outside of the marketing room and sales team in the business including customer support, the accounting team (it was all hands of deck lol) and even the real estate guys to log into the inbox where all the responses were coming in from to batch send them to different sales guys to handle so no lead was left uncontacted or closed who responded back.
It works unbelievably well. I had to dig 8 years back to find that original example for you from the first time I tried it out, and you better believe that over that 8 years I've sent that out on behalf of

businesses plenty of times with equally as great of a result, it's truly amazing for flooding the sales team with leads.

Conclusion

At this point if you've read this far, first off congratulations–you're loaded with new ideas I'm sure you're ready to go execute on in order to make more money from your list.

I'm honored to help you in your journey further, I have a few different offers to plug that can help you more including:

- Master Internet Marketing: a comprehensive 7 week class on how to master all things digital marketing, it's my favorite course in terms of everything I've released over the years.
- Jeremy's Inner Circle Program: We do masterminds at my house here in Miami 4 times a year, twice a month, 1 on 1 calls for 30 minutes each, and weekly group coaching calls. It's full of 60-70 high earning marketers, agency owners, brand owners, ecommerce owners, and info product creators that all share openly about anything that can help in getting richer. Only consider this if you're interested in making a lot more money, we don't want people who tolerate less from themselves in there.
- High Ticket Agency: This is my course on how to start and scale a marketing agency. Packed with 600+ video lessons all updated and current, dozens of SOPs to make running your agency more seamless and efficient, legal agreements to model after, along with a thriving community of thousands of other agency owners.
- Megalodon Marketing: My agency is always open to scaling a business to 6-7 figures monthly and beyond, if you're interested in working with us shoot me an email at ceo@jeremy.expert and describe what you want help scaling!

I hope you've enjoyed this SOP, give me a follow on Instagram and Twitter (yeah we know it's called X now… but we all still call it Twitter anyways).